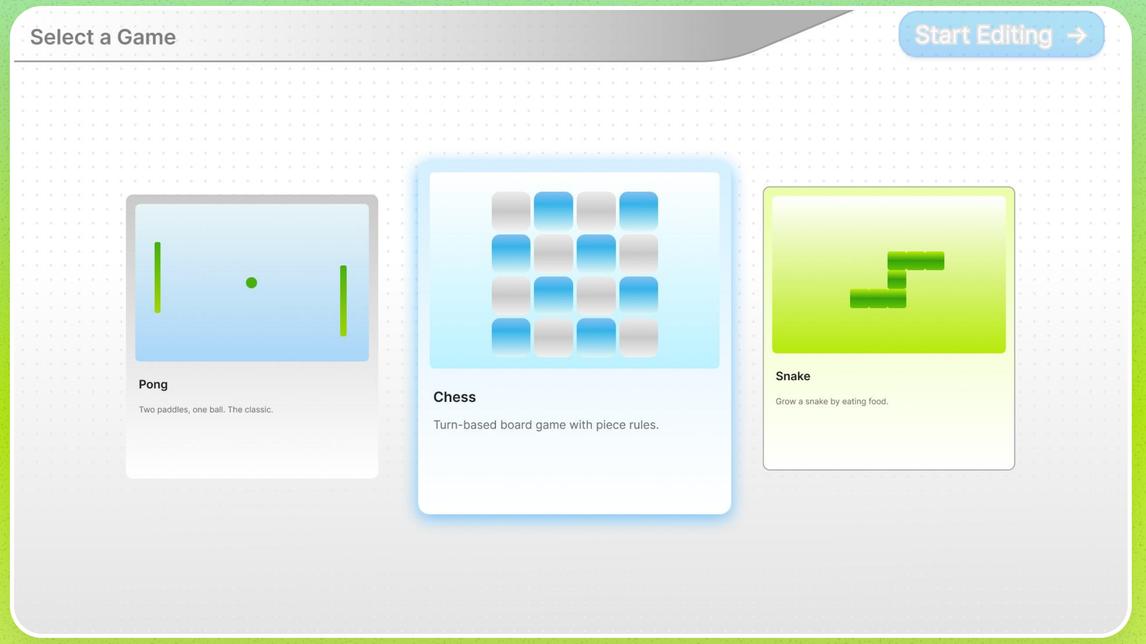
Game Education Software

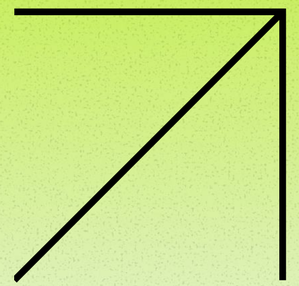


Mid-term

PRESENTED BY

Olivia · Julia · Hanif · Nat · Nolan

What we'll cover today



01 Who is our client?
02 Project background
03 Initial research
04 Development process
05 Issues
06 Where are we now?
07 Where are we going?

The Philosophy...

Pippin is an **Associate Professor in Design and Computation Arts** at Concordia University, and a game designer whose experimental games question how games work.

The Artist Is Present (2011) turns Marina Abramović's MoMA performance into a game about waiting your turn.

"I am writing a book about game design titled Playing the Variation Game which involves proposing a way to learn game design by creating variations on simple pre-existing games [...] I'm interested in the idea of some "edutainment" software that would allow a user with no technical experience to create variations of a specific underlying game through a simple user interface. " - Pippin Barr



Pippin Barr

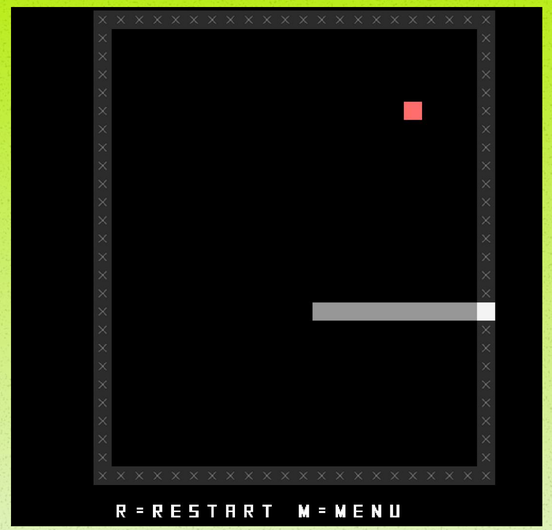


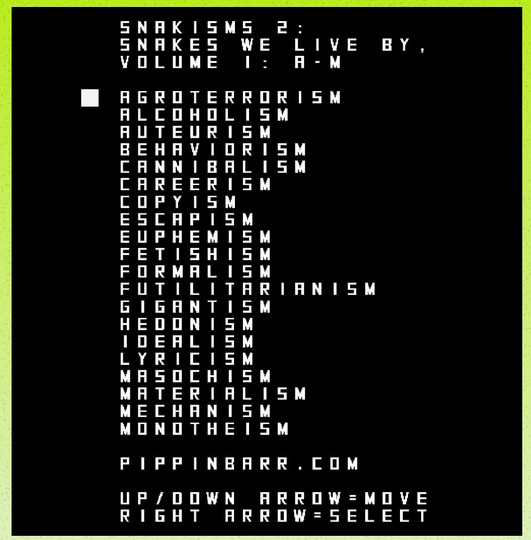
The Artist Is Present, 2011

Playing the Variation Game

Core Values

- “Radical Experimentation”
- Putting the “play” back into game-making
- “From the eyes of a child” … why are they so much better at creating?





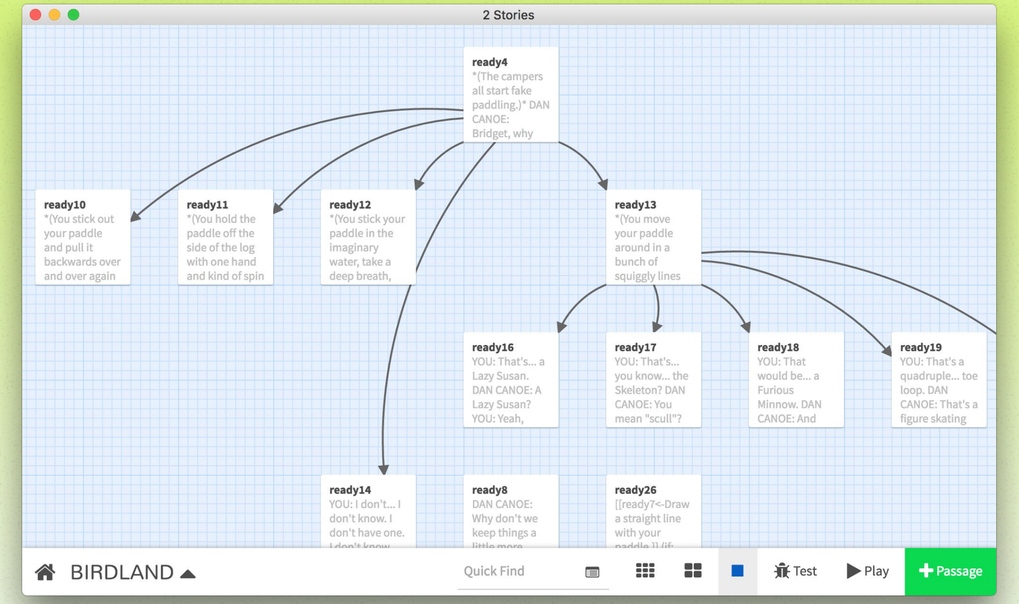
“More than anything, as a design you have to commit yourself to figuring out… that is, to really try to… you have to work out the… to be honest, I'm not always sure what to call it […] George Saunders who, discussing short stories, calls it the "heart" and says we must ask "When all is said and done, what do you claim to live by, [game]?"” - Pippin Barr, Playing the Variation Game

Research

“How to make a game learning software based on game design?”

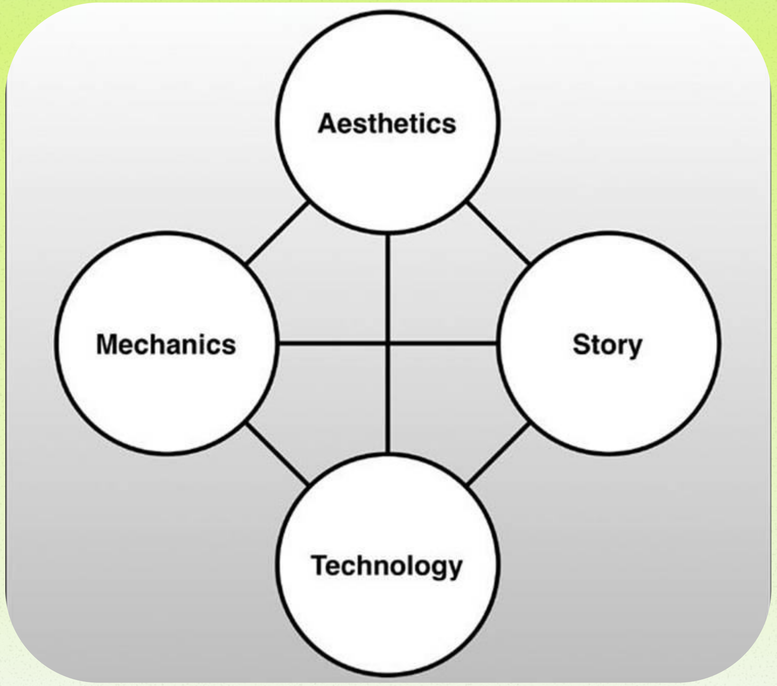
Technology

Twine

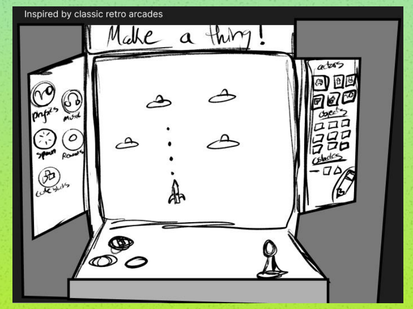


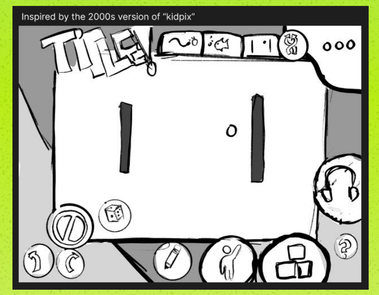
The literature

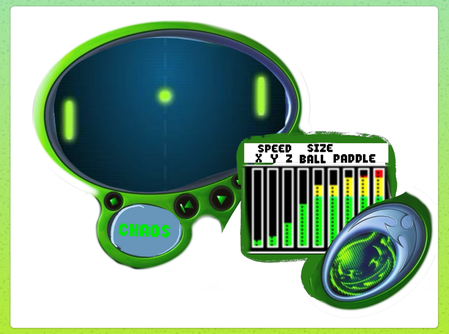
"The Art of Game Design" by Jesse Schell



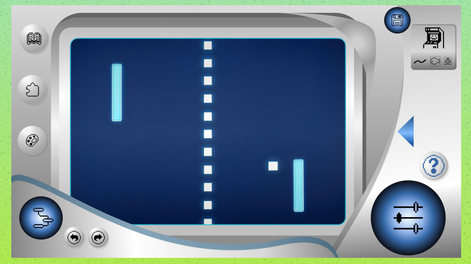
Early Visual Development

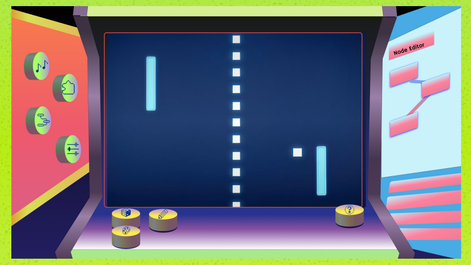


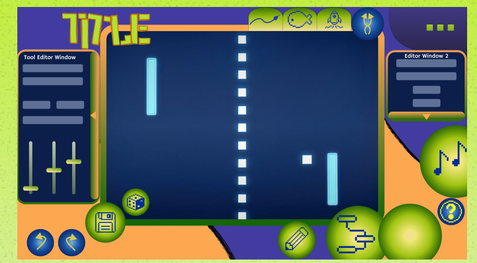








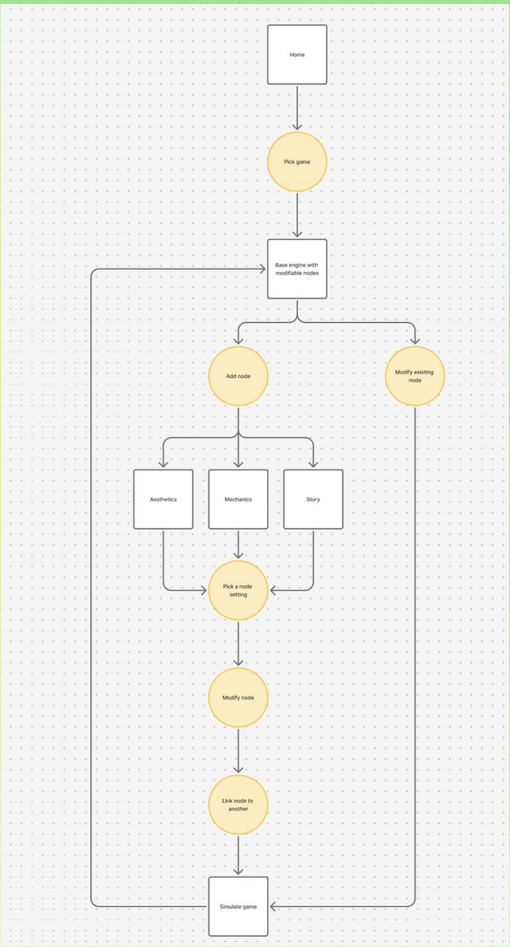


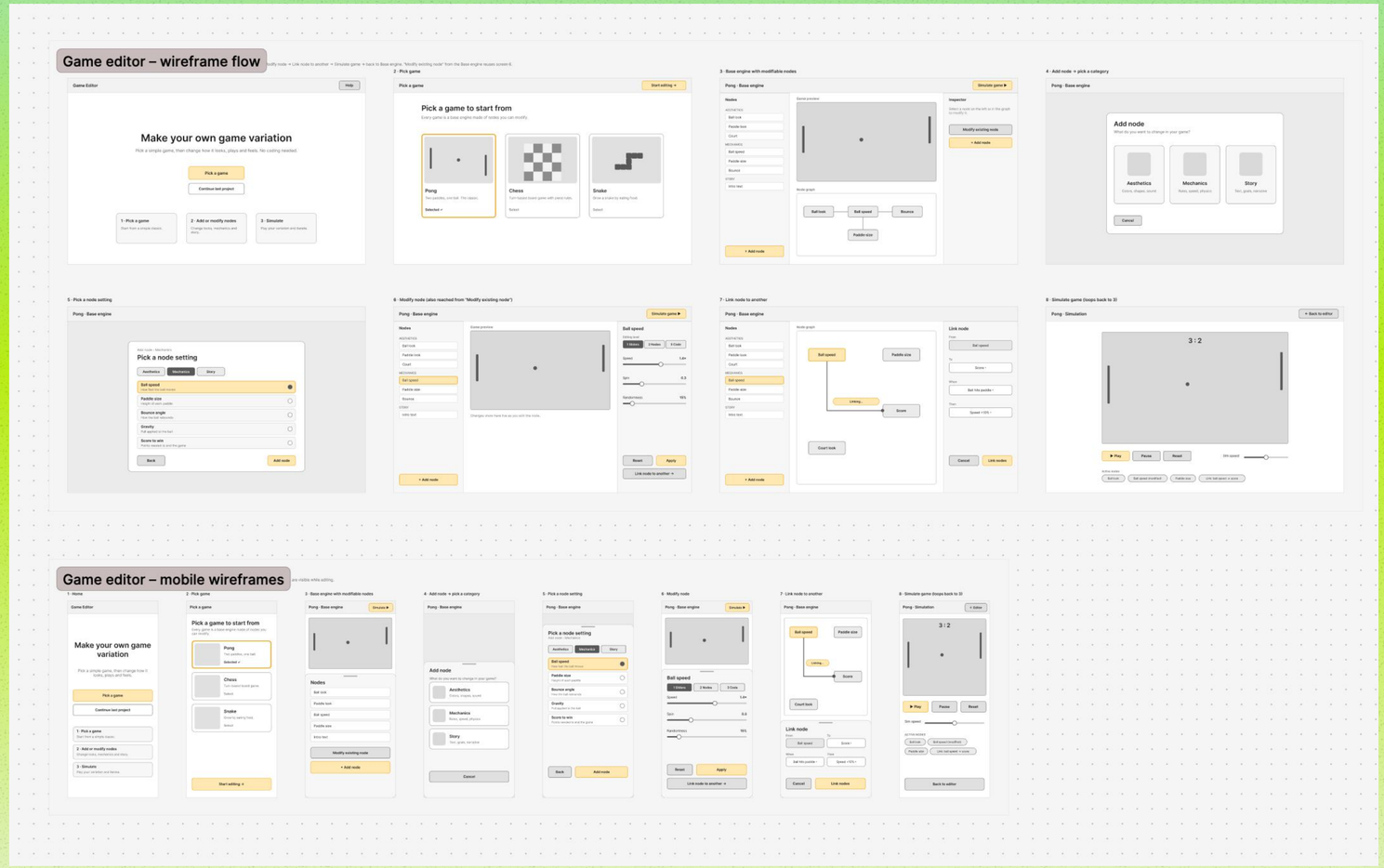




Current Visual Style

Early Wireframe Development



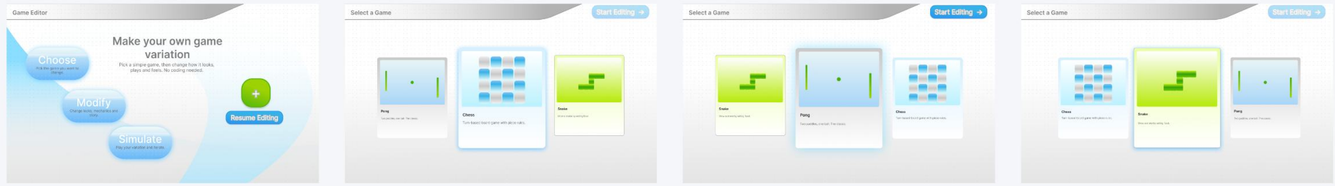


AI-assisted: first-draft wireframe generated with Claude via Figma MCP, then redesigned by hand.

Early Wireframe Development

1 · Start a game

Home → Pick Game. Clicking a side card brings it to the middle. Start Editing only works when Pong is selected.



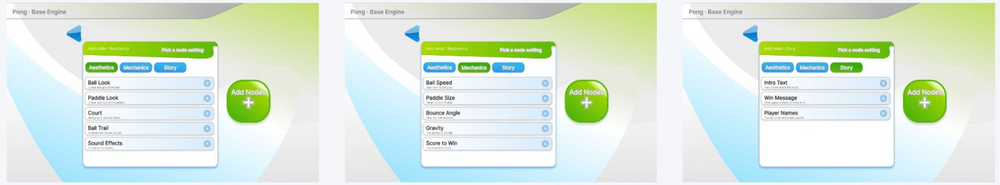
2 · Game view — Quick Editor

The canvas is a live preview. Click a node in "In Your Game" to edit its values. Drag the Speed slider → 04. Inspector → Add Node. Node Editor toggle → node view.



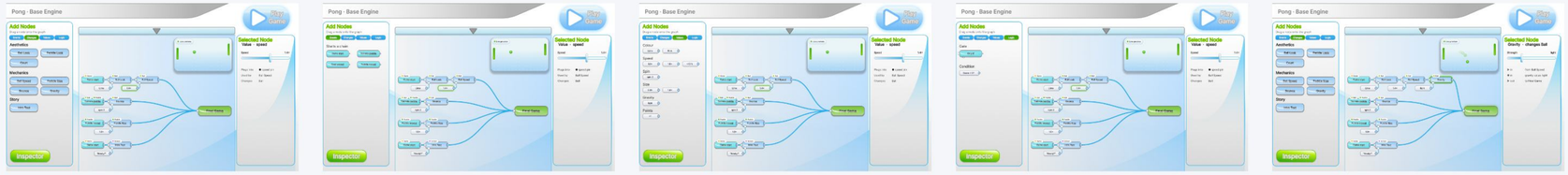
3 · Add a node (Inspector)

Tabs switch category. Click a row to select it, click again to deselect. Add Nodes → 07 (adds Gravity).



4 · Node view

Typed pins: ▶ flow, ● value, hexagon = condition. Out pins filled, in pins hollow. Palette tabs Events · Changes · Values · Logic. Drag Gravity (08) → 07. Right panel = Selected Node. Mini live preview top-right.



Issues/Obstacles

CURRENT OBSTACLES

Design Language

- design language is tricky, how to prioritize/balance “radical experimentation” with readability?
- Pippin rethinking our choice of “techno-zen” style, does it feel too “classy” or “clean”?

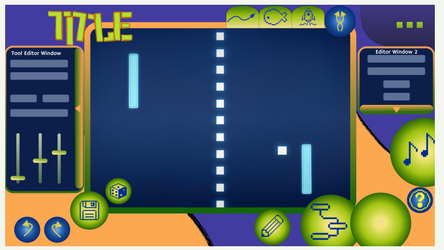
Technical Limits

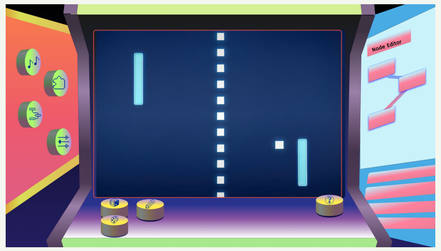
- How to determine limits of vague scope for a big project
- Determine most important tools to prototype

Choosing a Platform

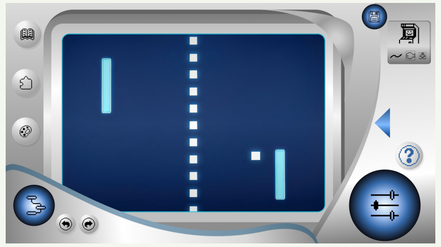
- Different ways to prototype: p5, Unity, Something else?

Older designs showed a more clear emphasis on “radical experimentation”





Older designs deemed too difficult to easily read



Next steps before the final

PLAN AND DATES STILL TO SUPPLY

1

Step 1: Add as many malleable features as we can to a p5 version of Pong

2

Edit the visual language again to reflect the chaotic nature of the project

3

Combine these to arrive at a more complete prototype

Try it

Make, break and play pong!



Olivia · Julia · Hanif · Nat · Nolan